

Del Pilar, Marcelo H. 1888. *La Frailocracia Filipina*, trans. Leonor Agrava, 33-43. Manila: National Historical Institute, 2009.

Marcelo H. del Pilar was born in Cupang, Bulacan on 30 August 1850 to Julian H. del Pilar and Blasa Gatmaitan. He first began schooling with a private tutor, Mr. Flores, and proceeded to study at the University of Santo Tomas where he obtained his bachelor's degree and law degree.

Early on, he became involved in anti-friar activities. He founded the *Diariong Tagalog* on 1 June 1882. Later, he led anti-friar movements in Malolos. Because of the fear of reprisal for his anti-friar activities, Del Pilar left the Philippines in 1889. He arrived in Spain and continued writing in *La Solidaridad*. From 1890 until the end of the newspaper's publication, Del Pilar served as its editor.

The following work by Del Pilar, "La Frailocracia Filipina," was first published in Barcelona in 1889 and was written as a response to a pamphlet titled, "Los Frailes en Filipinas." In this work, Del Pilar criticized the power of the friars in the country and called for radical reforms in the Philippines.

71

Del Pilar, Marcelo H. 1888. *Aba Guinoong Baria*. In *Buhay at mga Sinulat ni Plaridad*, ed. Jose P. Santos, 14. Maynila: Palimbag ng DALAGA.

Marcelo H. del Pilar was born in Cupang, Bulacan on 30 August 1850 to Julian H. del Pilar and Blasa Gatmaitan. He first began schooling with a private tutor, Mr. Flores, and proceeded to study at the University of Santo Tomas where he obtained his bachelor's degree and law degree.

Early on, he became involved in anti-friar activities. He founded the *Diariong Tagalog* on 1 June 1882. Later, he led anti-friar movements in Malolos. Because of the fear of reprisal for his anti-friar activities, Del Pilar left the Philippines in 1889. He arrived in Spain and continued writing in *La Solidaridad*. From 1890 until the end of the newspaper's publication, Del Pilar served as its editor.

The following work by Del Pilar, "Aba Guinoong Baria," is a satire found in a collection called *Dasalan at Tocsohan*, which was said to have been co-written by Pedro Serrano Laktaw and Rafael Enriquez. The short poem, along with others like it in the collection, illustrates the avariciousness of friars in the Philippines. It drives home the point Del Pilar aimed to express: that the corruption of Philippine society can be blamed on the greed of the friars.

Excerpt :

Aba Guinoong Baria

Aba guinoong Baria nacapupuno ca nang alcancia ang Fraile'I sumasainyo bucod ca niyang pinagpala't pina higuít sa lahat, pinagpala naman ang caban mong ma-pasoc. Santa Baria Ina nang Deretsos, ipanalangin mo coming huag anitan ngayon at cami ipapatay. Siya naua.

Ang Aba Po Santa Baria

Aba po Santa Bariang Hari, inagao nang Fraile, icao ang cabuhayan at catamisan. Aba bunga nang aming pauis, icao ang pinagpaguran naming pinapanaw na tauong Anac ni Eva, icao nga ang ipinagbubuntong hininga naming sa aming pagtangis dito sa bayang pinacahapishapis. Ay aba pinacahanaphanap naming para sa aming manga anac, ilingon mo sa aming ang cara- i cruz mo man lamang at saca bago matapos ang pagpanaw mo sa amin ay iparinig mo sa amin ang iyong calasing Santa Baria ina nang deretsos, malacas at maalam, matunog na guinto cami ipanalangin mong huag magpatuloy sa aming ang manga banta nang Fraile. Amen.

72

Edmund Plauchut. 1877. The Philippine Islands. In *La Solidaridad*, Vol. 2: 1890, trans. Guadalupe Fores-Ganzon, 62-75. Pasig City: Fundación Santiago.

On the 20th year anniversary of the execution of the three priests, Jose Burgos, Mariano Gomez, and Jacinto Zamora, the newspaper *La Solidaridad* published Edmund Plauchut's account of the execution. The first hand account by the Frenchman resident of Manila was originally published in the French journal, *Revue des Deux Mondes* in 1877. Plauchut's account has often been called "the Filipino version" of the events that transpired in 1872. The historian John N. Schumacher, however, found the account problematic, citing inconsistencies in statements and the lack of knowledge on background events in the Philippines. Schumacher also contended that it was not clear whether Plauchut was really in the Philippines during the period of 1869 to 1873. This only led Schumacher to believe that it was highly likely that the account written by Plauchut was itself inspired and aided by at least one political prisoner, Antonio Regidor, who was imprisoned after the events of 1872. Therefore, while the "Filipino version" of the events of 1872 may contain biases towards the Filipinos, it should be read in the context of early propaganda efforts. The account published in *La Solidaridad* may indeed be "dramatic" according to Schumacher, but the motives behind the writing of such an account contributes knowledge on the workings of a propaganda efforts that preceded even Rizal's generation.

Excerpt:

Late in the night of the 15th of February 1872, a Spanish court martial found three secular priests, Jose Burgos, Mariano Gomez and Jacinto Zamora, guilty of treason as the instigators of a mutiny in the Kabite navy-yard a month before, and sentenced them to death. The judgement of the court martial was read to the priests in Fort Santiago early in the next morning and they were told it would be executed the following day... Upon hearing the sentence, Burgos broke into sobs, Zamora lost his mind and never recovered it, and only Gomez listened impassively, an old

man accustomed to the thought of death.

When dawn broke on the 17th of February there were almost forty thousand of Filipinos (who came from as far as Bulakan, Pampanga, Kabite and Laguna) surrounding the four platforms where the three priests and the man whose testimony had convicted them, a former artilleryman called Saldua, would die.

The three priests followed Saldua: Burgos 'weeping like a child', Zamora with vacant eyes, and Gomez head held high, blessing the Filipinos who knelt at his feet, heads bared and praying. He was next to die. When his confessor, a Recollect friar, exhorted him loudly to accept his fate, he replied: "Father, I know that not a leaf falls to the ground but by the will of God. Since He wills that I should die here, His holy will be done."

Zamora went up the scaffold without a word and delivered his body to the executioner; his mind had already left it.

73

Burgos was the last, a refinement of cruelty that compelled him to watch the death of his companions. He seated himself on the iron rest and then sprang up crying: "But what crime have I committed? Is it possible that I should die like this. My God, is there no justice on earth?"

A dozen friars surrounded him and pressed him down again upon the seat of the garrote, pleading with him to die a Christian death. He obeyed but, feeling his arms tied round the fatal post, protested once again: "But I am innocent!"

"So was Jesus Christ," said one of the friars." At this Burgos resigned himself. The executioner knelt at his feet and asked his forgiveness. "I forgive you, my son. Do your duty." And it was done.

74

Sinibaldo de Mas, *Internal Political Condition of the Philippines* (1842). In Emma Blair and James Robertson (eds.), *The Philippine Islands, 1493-1898* (Cleveland: The Arthur H. Clark, Co., 1903-1907), vol. 52, pp. 29-90.

The Internal Conditions of the Philippines was a controversial report written by Sinibaldo de Mas, a Spanish official in the Philippines, and diplomat in Asia in the mid-nineteenth century. This secret report was part of the third volume of Mas' three-volume work on the Philippines. The first two volumes were on the historical background of the colony, the various challenges it was facing at the time, and its need for a more effective and efficient colonial administration. First published confidentially in Madrid in 1842, and then publicly the following year with a very few copies released, *The Internal Conditions* discussed Spain's three intentions with regard to the Philippines: perpetual possession, utter neglect, and emancipation. Mas focused on the first and third intentions, although he advocated the latter (emancipation) as he "cannot see what benefits [Spain could gain] from the colonies." The text below is part of Mas' discussion on the three principles that would allow Spain to control the Philippines in perpetuity. The focus here is the second principle.

Excerpt:

In order to conserve the colony, it is necessary, in my opinion, to work with reference to the spirit of the following three principles, which I shall endeavor successively to explain: 1st: It is advisable to reduce the Spanish-Filipino population to the least possible number. 2nd: The ¹¹ people of color must voluntarily give respect and obedience to the whites. 3rd: The general ^{12 13} administration demands a complete reform.

...

2nd. People of color must voluntarily respect and obey the whites. In order to attain this object, it is necessary to maintain the former race in an intellectual and moral condition which will make of their numerical majority a political force less than that which resides in the second, just as a pile of straw in the balance weighs less than a gold nugget. The farmer or the goatherd does not read social contracts, or know more than what takes place in his own village. This is not the class of people who have overthrown absolutism in *España*, but that class who are educated in the ¹⁴ colleges, and who know the price of guarantees, and fight for them. We must not depart from this point of view, if we are to discuss the matter sincerely. The making of liberals must be ¹⁵ necessarily avoided, for in a colony the words liberal and insurgent are synonymous. The

Insulares or Philippine-born Spaniards in the Philippines. ¹¹

Mas was referring to the native inhabitants of the colony ¹²

These were the “white” Spaniards in the colony. ¹³

¹⁴ The absolute power of a monarch

¹⁵ Educated individuals who advocated the recognition of the rights of the people

75

consequence of the idea will be to admit the principle that each step forward is a treading backward. It is necessary to circumscribe the education to primary schools where reading, writing, and arithmetic will be taught, continuing as at present with one school in each village, and leaving their direction to the *curas*. The colleges for males now existing in Manila must be ¹⁶ closed. In English India, whose educational institutions and free government are of so much ¹⁷ weight with some, there is nothing similar to this, and an Englishman who wishes to become a lawyer, a notary, a physician, or a military or civil official, has to go to England for study and graduation—I say Englishman, for the natives do not even enter into the question.

In the service of arms, they must not rise beyond privates or at the most corporals. It is much ¹⁸ better to make a sergeant or officer from a Spanish farmer, even though he cannot read and write, than from the more capable native. On the contrary, the more dexterous and deserving is the

latter, so much greater will be the mistake committed. Here the one who plays for gain loses. It is less dangerous and more tolerable to bestow the rank of officer on a very stupid, vicious, and cowardly fellow.

Priests, belonging to the religious orders, who administered the parishes ¹⁶

¹⁷ During that time, India was a crown colony of the British

Referring to the native inhabitants of the Philippines ¹⁸